

OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE EDITORIAL PAGE

OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE

Published Every Friday
E. E. BRODIE, Editor and Publisher.

Entered at Oregon City, Oregon, Post
office as second-class matter.

SUBSCRIPTION RATES
1 Year \$1.50
6 Months75
3 Months40

Subscribers will find the date of expiration stamped on their papers following their name. If last payment is not credited, kindly notify us, and the matter will receive our attention.

Advertising Rates on application.

HOPE FROM ASHES

GAUNT RUINS, bearing the mark of the greatest tragedy in the history of the state are today the Astoria that but brief hours ago was renowned as a seaport and industrial center. The loss that cannot yet be estimated has been wrenched from one of the most prosperous parts of Oregon, has taken its toll in a single morning.

The first question is one of immediate relief. The state of Oregon as a unit, and its cities individually, have responded nobly to the call for aid. Within three weeks the entire immediate need will have been met and the mouth of the Columbia River will be faced with the real gigantic task which the catastrophe brings on—What is to be done to rebuild the devastated area?

From the earthquake, San Francisco traces the period of its greatest growth. Mrs. O'Leary's cow is associated with the comparatively recent development of Chicago. That the improvement is brought about by disaster is not because of misfortune itself but because of the spirit of accomplishment which it arouses.

"We have no city," said Mayor James Bremner on the afternoon of the fire, "but we still have the greatest harbor on the coast."

He was expressing for the people characteristic American determination to replace, rebuild and prosper despite odds of the greatest weight.

The helping hand of the remainder of the state will be extended to Astoria in its rehabilitation work. Its only salvation lies in the reconstruction of its shattered commercial and mercantile organization. In Astoria should be found the best opportunity for the thousands that have become homeless or poverty stricken.

But no matter how much grit and determination are displayed, the city cannot be rebuilt without aid. The chief requirement is extensive credit both on the part of the creditors of the lost business houses and on the part of those who are in a position to aid new investment.

Other cities have set the example. From the ashes a new hope has arisen, instilled with faith in the future, and with a vision of a greater and better development. No measure can assuage the loss. There remains only the new accomplishment and new attainment to in some degree blot out the tragic memory of December 8, 1922.

THE HOME MERCHANTS

WITH CHRISTMAS shopping coming to full tide within a few days, it is timely to urge the patronage of home industries and the doing as much as possible of the holiday buying in one's own section of the town.

Every merchant at this season takes special thought for supplying his customers. If he knows of their desires in time, he can add things to his stock which ordinarily he would not carry even at the gift season. Too often he is criticised for not carrying an extensive line when all he needs is the incentive.

Much of the home merchant's profit goes back into the town. All of it helps him to raise the standard of his service at all seasons. He gives of his best in ordinary times. He should have first call when larger spending is in order.

GOVERNMENT OWNERSHIP

THERE ARE dark days ahead for the productive industries of the United States if, as some writers profess to believe, the recent election foretells legislation antagonistic to the railroads. The transportation system has just recently emerged from a period of suppression due in part to complex government regulation and in part to government ownership.

For many years state and national regulatory bodies have limited freight and passenger rates and the revenues to be derived therefrom. Coincident with that limitation of income, there was no compensatory limitation of expense. Under such a policy the net earnings of the railroads steadily diminished, upkeep was neglected and the financial resources of the roads became so bad that their credit was impaired.

Following that long period of strangling regulation came the period of government management when there was a studied increase of cost of operation, demoralization of the operating forces and no corresponding increase in revenues. The roads were turned back to their private owners in almost a bankrupt condition, but with an opportunity under the provisions of the Transportation Act to restore themselves to somewhere near a satisfactory business basis.

At the present time there is a shortage of cars and locomotives, which shortage is bringing loss to many a producer who has goods to ship. Construction and extension of terminals has not kept pace with the growth of industry throughout the country. Double-tracks, side tracks and other improvements designed to facilitate the prompt and economical handling of traffic have been necessarily neglected. If the country needs any one thing today it needs an improved, dependable and a prosperous transportation system, ready at all times

to carry all the goods American producers have to offer and operated under that standard of efficiency which can be attained only under private management, where competition for business furnishes the incentive.

Legislation antagonistic to the railroads now can mean only one thing—bankruptcy and government ownership and operation. In bankruptcy and government ownership means cheaper or better transportation service, such an outcome might well be welcomed, but experience in this country and elsewhere demonstrates that an opposite result would be suffered. There is nothing to be gained by the people of the country in operating railroads at less than cost and paying the deficits out of the public treasury.

Probably no one will question the statement that government operation is more expensive and less efficient than private operation. Ultimately the costs must fall upon producers and consumers who must pay either through freight and passenger rates or through taxes. Neither the farmer, nor the manufacturer, nor the professional man, nor the city laborer has anything to gain by forcing the railroads into government ownership.

Yet, if common interpretations of the recent election are correct, that seems to be the direction toward which we are bound. Moreover, this movement is accelerated by the activity of a considerable body of bolsheviks who would be glad to see the railroads wrecked in order to force the only alternative—government ownership and operation.

THE TRAGIC EXAMPLE

OREGON CITY has been almost passive in the fact of a \$350,000 fire loss. A hundred miles away the heart of a city was eaten out by fire. The difference is only in the amount of the loss, a mere chance that prevented the holocaust from being visited upon this community.

Oregon City has one piece of apparatus. In the face of the condition that baffled the Astoria fire department, Oregon City would be helpless. Fire Chief Foster, one of the best firemen in the state, declared that several fires broke out simultaneously, engulfing the entire business district in flames.

If this should happen in Oregon City, what chance would the department have. A fire in the business district and in the residence district at the same time would probably repeat the Astoria disaster here.

Chief Wm. Friebe of the local department has asked for another piece of apparatus and 1,000 more feet of hose. Thinking citizens will well consider the advisability of granting the request. It is not too late for action at the budget meeting on the 15th the appropriation can be arranged for part of what is desired and if necessary, an additional tax can later be voted.

With the necessity patent for reduction of expenditures it seems inconsistent to advocate more fire apparatus. But there are some things which are of vital necessity. Oregon City's good fortune has saved a greater loss than has been occasioned. What the future holds in store cannot be told but it should not take loss of life and property here to convince the people that ample provision should be made for fighting such a menace. The frightful devastation in Astoria should be sufficient example.

The Hawley mill is not looking for a location other than Oregon City, according to W. P. Hawley. Any improvements are to be made at Oregon City, he declares, apparently realizing that the possibilities for expansion here have far from been reached. What Oregon City needs is more payrolls. A real campaign for industrial growth here should be undertaken either by the commercial club or the city itself.

The workmen who were sentenced to the penitentiary for the theft of an overcoat probably accomplished his objective—he will keep warm this winter.

Astoria rebuilt itself in 1883. History in this case can well afford to repeat.

The value of Turkish demands seems to be materially affected by who they are made to.

Kid McCoy has been married eight times and is now bankrupt. It often doesn't take that many.

Clara Philipps comes pretty close to being Roy Gardner number two.

Now that the flapper is out of style who is going to be next to be blamed?

The ex-Kaiser says he was "brought up with the Bible." The Bible, however, appears to have survived the experience without visible injury. —Nashville Southern Lumberman.

A three-year-old infant in New York City can speak five languages. By the time he grows up, he may be able to get around his home town without an interpreter. —Life.

Ambassador Harvey has been talking on the subject, "Have Women Souls?" He didn't answer the question, which goes to show that as a diplomat he is improving. —Toledo Blade.

The Irish Sea is nowhere more than 710 feet deep, says a contemporary. "We don't mind that so much," writes a correspondent, "but couldn't it be widened?" —Passing Show (London).

Paderewski has given up politics to return to the concert stage. This might suggest something to Mr. Hearst, who used to play in the banjo club at college. —Life.

The Poets' Corner.

Songs and Sonnets From the Pens of Modern Writers.

THE UNWILLING GYPSY

By Josephine Johnson
The wide green earth is mine in which to wander;
Each path that beckons I may follow free,
Sea to grey sea.
But O, that one walled garden, small and sheltered,
Belonged to me!
High on the mountain top I watch the sunset,
Its splendid fires flare upward and burn low,
Ah, once to know
Down in the twilight lowlands dim and tender,
My own hearth-glow!

Night falls. A thousand stars look down upon me.
But though from inland plain to ocean's foam
My steps may roam,
One clear fixed star forever is denied me . . .
The light of home!

THE CIRCUS CLOWN

By John Ferguson
With whitened scalp and nose bedaubed of red,
He bounds into the ring and cracks his wheeze;
Bursting with wit, he mounts a high trapeze,
Then falls into the net dispirited:
He mimics pyramids fed, and dread contortions of some "Modern Hercules."
While at his shins they throw a wooden cheese,
Or a soft turnip hits him on the head.

When tenting days are done, and ne'er more
He smells the sawdust, sees the laughing eyes,
I somehow think that on a daisied floor
He'll turn a somersault in Paradise
To give some angel-child a glad surprise.
Who never saw a circus clown before.
—London Graphic.

TURKISH DELIGHT

(From the original and surprising recipe of several contemporaries.)
By Lucio
The Turk he is a gentleman, a gentleman, a gentleman,
The Turk he is a gentleman and one of Nature's best!
And, oh, what black ingratitude to strike an angry attitude
And fix for him a latitude that's less than he possessed!

Throughout the war with Germany, with Germany, with Germany
Throughout the war with Germany, many for us, of course, he fought;
And only the censorious will grudge the label glorious
To all the meritorious assistance that he brought.
He helped us in Gallipoli, Gallipoli, Gallipoli,
He helped us in Gallipoli and Palestine no end;
Assisted by Bulgaria, enteric and malaria
Throughout the Eastern area, he acted like a friend!

So give him back his Capital, his Capital, his Capital,
The European Capital he stole for Asia's prey,
Lest after you posterity records with pained severity
That friendship and sincerity for Britain didn't pay!
—Manchester Guardian.

A MAN TO A WOMAN

By Angela Morgan
And you shall walk with other loves
Because I left you free;
Of other souls shall take your fill
Who loved the soul of me.
And you shall have your feast with those
Who never saw my face . . .
And yet beside you at the board
My heart shall have its place.

And though you seek for Arcady
Where once you sought for me,
And though with others you may share
Our Paradisaal tree,
So greatly doth your spirit hold
My being in its spell,
That he whose word shall comfort you
Shall comfort me as well.

In other climes and other years
Beyond the alluring sea,
Oh you shall go your wilful way
Who might have gone with me.
And you shall give to other loves
What you to me denied,
And you shall call him what you will
Who dwelleth by your side . . .

So deeply hath my spirit claimed
Its old captivity,
That he who clasps the form of you
Shall hold the heart of me.
With other friends the future years
Your cycle shall fulfill,
Yet I who stand from you apart . . .
I am your lover still!

TO THE URBANE

By Raymond Holden
Who can not drink the wild wind,
Must set dry lips to little pools,
Who can not feed upon sun-fire
Must wait until the sun cools.
So raise your towering city walls,
You miserable all!
Build strong roofs above your heads
To catch the stars that fall.

Stop your ears against the wind,
Ward the great light from your eyes,
Clothe the naked earth with cobbles,
Tell old horses you are wise!
—New York Evening Post.

Borrowed Comment.

What Editors of State and National Papers Have to Say.

Reading the newspapers we learn that the late election was a victory for the wets, for the dyes, for the Democrats, the Progressive Republicans, the farmers, the radical element, the conservatives, the League of Nations and some several other things. Thus does democracy vindicate itself. —Pine Valley Herald.

Senator Newberry won his election through the power of money. He escaped the penalty when indicted, through a court ruling. He was seated in the senate through the power of a political organization, but ultimately the people passed upon his case, and their verdict is final. —Astoria Budget.

Mary MacSwiney is on a hunger strike inside Mount Joy prison, Dublin, and her sister, Annie, is striking sympathetically outside the walls. If there were only a few more MacSwineys the high cost of living would soon be only a disquieting memory. —Eugene Guard.

Governor Olcott has lopped off the office of state water superintendent at \$2400 a year. Good job; several hundred useless sapsuckers might be fired in the state and counties—and that would be a long step toward the goal of lower taxation. —Eugene Guard.

A pinhead politician is one of those fellows who cannot get the idea into his head that the public looks upon him as a public servant—nothing more, nothing less. And servants are usually required to make good. —Roseburg News-Review.

Those who are figuring on the Smith vote to carry Al Smith into the White House, might better also look forward to the time when all of those Smiths would be crowding around and hollering, "You know me, Al!" —Oregon Journal.

Owing to the calm conditions existing at home and abroad and all around, choirs ought to be able to sing anthems about "peace on earth, good will to man," with some gusto this Christmas. —Medford Mail-Tribune.

Hood River has started off on the Governor-elect Pierce program, all right. The city school board and the city budget board are all reducing taxes. If the county budget board will all be happy. —Hood River Glacier.

Edison is reported to have said that college students are afraid of the kind of work where they get their clothes dirty. Shucks! He ought to see an Oregon football game. —Eugene Register.

A man with a coffin in his truck was arrested for speeding in Chicago. Well, if they're bound to do it, that's the thing to carry. —American Lumberman (Chicago).

Used to wonder what history was, anyhow. Now we have figured it is just putting one scrape after another in book form, and how it got started, and who got licked. —Amity Standard.

Evidently the people regard it as more important that the Republican party should keep its promises than that Republican congressmen should keep their jobs. —Weston Leader.

The press agent knows his business, of course, but when it's a case of a naughty book you've got to hand it to the suppress agent. —Oregon Journal.

"Congressman has asked for more bars on immigration." Some folks claim to think our lack of bars is curtailing immigration somewhat. —Oregon Journal.

"Win men by mentality" says a famous French actress. Good looks, however, won't be regarded as a handicap. —Corvallis Gazette Times.

Budget director says United States will live within its income next year. But will it live within ours? —Albany Democrat.

What this country needs isn't more liberty but fewer people who take liberties with our liberty. —Roseburg News-Review.

Gossip may engage Charlie Chaplin every day, but it takes a minister or somebody to marry him. —Oregon Journal.

What the over-harassed ex-ultant needs more than anything else is a few hundred ex-wives. —Oregon Journal.

When the old cow went dry we named her Portland. Now that the poor critter's dead, shouldn't we call her Seattle. —Oregon Journal.

The election is over, but the legislature still has to be organized. It's just one thing after another in this world. —Eugene Register.

Every city has residents who are willing to ride free on the chariot of progress and share in the profits which accrue to those who are doing the pushing. —Baker Herald.

"Fish supply shows variety," comments the market editor. Probably the variety is "big fish" and "poor fish." —Oregon Journal.

Of course, the army beats the navy at football. But it might be different if they fought it out on a typical Oregon gridiron. —Eugene Guard.

The Office Cat.

By Junius.

If a man has a hard time keeping his head above water, it is time to get out of the deep water.

TWO DEFINITIONS

Optimist: Sick man learning to play a harp.
Pessimist: Sick man learning to shovel coal.

Alfred is so very fat
Alleen so very lean,
So, you see, between them
Both
They fill a Ford machine.

An officer was showing an old lady over the battleship.

"This," said he pointing to an inscribed plate on the desk, "is where our gallant captain fell."
"No wonder," replied the old lady: "I nearly slipped on it myself."

TWO FACED GIRL, LUKE?

It is all right for a girl to believe that the fact should be left exposed. The trouble is that she imagines her face runs all the way down to the wristbone. —Luke McLuke.

"One of the features of raising a family is that in a few years you are sure to have some gangling youth with a face resembling a mouldy green apple pie hanging around with smiles for your 15-year-old daughter."

You can tell whether you are old or young by whether you believe the golden age is past or just dawning.

WISDOM?

Blessed are they into whose dust God never moulded the wanderer lust. For the sweat from the brow of the men who roam will turn to gold for the stay at home. And he who goes where the long trail calls will spend his life in overalls. But there are times, I will admit, when all my chores I long to quit and cast aside my heavy load and join the hobo on the road.

The way to success is—Turn to the right and keep going.

"Can dogs find their way home from a long distance? It's according to the dog. If it's one you want to get rid of, he can find his way back home from Alaska. If it's a good one, he's apt to get lost if he goes around the corner."

SOME JOB

"John, your face looks terribly battered up," said the teacher to John aged seven.
"You haven't been fighting on the way to school, have you?" he inquired.

"No," said John, "we moved yesterday and I had to carry the cat."

The press agent of a black pugilist announces the day before the fight that his man is in the pink of condition to make the opponent feel blue.

UP ON HIS NATURE STUDY

"What is this?" asked the teacher, holding up the picture of a zebra.
"A horse in a bathing suit," replied Tommy Simpkins.

A man has no business in taking unto himself a wife unless he has the disposition to submit to being bossed at least part of the time.

EASTERN STANDARD

"Johnny, don't you know it's Sunday? You mustn't play marbles out there on the sidewalk. Go into the back yard if you want to play."

"All right, mother, but what day of the weeks is it in the back yard?"

SEE THROUGH THIS?

She—"What would you call a man who hid behind a woman's skirts?"

A CURIOSITY RHYME

Hy Diddle-Didde,
Was fat in the middle,
So he bought a bike to reduce.
He rode and he rode around
Till he gained eight fifty pounds.
But he wore the bike down;
It lost ten pounds.
Now to be sure, ain't that the deuce?

IN NOSEPAINT GULCH

"Now don't get skeered if a man reaches for his hip pocket. He may be gonna offer you his bottle."

"I'd rather face a shot from the gun."

MAKING IT EASY

A lawyer earning \$3,000 a year was insured for \$25,000. He got shipwrecked and was miraculously rescued. Reaching land, after the news of his death had been broadcasted, he cabled to his partner:

"Saved. Try to break the news gently to my wife."

You will find the prisons full of fellows who tried to take the short cut to success.

ESSAY ON PANTS

Pants are made for men and not for women. Women are made for men and not for pants. When a man pants for a woman and a woman pants for a man, that makes a pair of pants. Pants are like molasses; they are thinner in hot weather and thicker in cold weather.

There has been much discussion as to whether pants is singular or plural. Seems to us that when men wear pants it is plural, and when they don't wear pants it is singular.

If you want to make the pants last, make the coat first.

The Book Corner.

By C. E. G.

JOANNA GORDEN: by Sheila Kaye-Smith. E. P. Dutton and Company, New York.

That remarkable crisis of nature when from the grubby cocoon emerges a gaily colored butterfly, has something of the same element of surprise that Sheila Kaye-Smith has written in to the title character of her novel, "Joanna Godden." A huge, blown golden butterfly of the marsh country is Joanna, who though she may not dance about on the light feet that are usually attributed to human butterflies, she may be well identified with the species. There is something about Joanna's way of flashing about, always seeking for something of which she has no knowledge and banging into things she cannot see that makes one think of blind butterflies.

Joanna is the character of the story. All other people are mere shadows drawn to accentuate the color of her personality. She is no cuddly little heroine, but a big, warm-hearted woman, who accomplishes a man's work, and has all the longings of any normal girl. A queer combination is Joanna, promising to lead into strange adventure, and throughout the story she lives up to expectation.

The first part of the book is devoted to Joanna's efforts to better the financial and social condition of herself and her small sister, Ellen. She manages this very nicely, by a combination of daring and devilry, and the wearing of magnificent costumes. When Joanna wants anything she goes after it with all the simplicity and stubbornness of a child, but she discovers that this way of procedure does not work out well when applied to the task of acquiring a husband. Most of the males of the neighborhood want to be sure of their place as head of the family before taking the final step, and marrying a woman with more money, brains and will-power does not anger well for masculine superiority. For a brief period the character of the girl softens under the tenderness of a real love given and received from a well-born young man of the country.

Joanna understands at lot about crops and farming, but she knows little of human nature, and her headstrong bullying ways finally drive her sister out of the home into the arms of a man of questionable character. After a few disagreeable months Ellen returns, but Joanna takes a hard view of the affair and makes the girl's life miserable.

Fate is not nearly through with Joanna, however, and she plunges on from one foolhardy thing to another until she eventually becomes involved in a most unpleasant experience for which she never even has insured nature can find an escape. So we leave Joanna, who has traveled up the hill and started down, but who may find other hills before her to climb and other men to love.

The story presents a wealth of human experience, and gives unlimited attention to a character in the making. It is interesting from many viewpoints, but chiefly as a study of a type which is not often encountered—in books.

Unerring diplomacy is distinguished from imperialistic intent largely by the point of view. It is this that the attitude of Gabriel D'Annunzio is seen not only in his Italy of the Italians' but to the rest of the world and especially to Great Britain and to Mr. Woodrow Wilson.

Quoting from the Chicago Tribune's extracts of the new book of the poet, political leader and warrior, Gullio Bahralla picks the following paragraphs as the most striking in the entire volume.

"The voracious empire, which self-appropriated Persia, Mesopotamia, New Arabia and the greatest part of Africa, and it is never satisfied, may launch against Italy those same aerial assassins, who in Egypt did not feel any blame when killing rebels armed with limbs of trees. The greedy empire, which gazes at Constantinople and conceals its possession of at least one-third of China and which has seized all the rich islands in the Pacific south of the equator, may use against me the same means. I have executed against the exhausted people of Punjab, which were denounced by Rabindranath Tagore, such means that had no comparison in the history of civilized government.

"We shall be victorious. All rebels of all kinds will come under our banners. And force shall be opposed by force. And there will be a new crusade of all poor, impoverished nations, a new crusade of all poor and free men, against usurper nations, which are accumulating wealth, against caste ururers, who yesterday abused war as today they are using peace. Let us have a new crusade to re-establish true justice which a cold foolish man, crucified with 14 blunt nails, and used a hammer lent him by a German chancellor."

The International Book Review, a monthly publication, is to be issued shortly by the Literary Digest, according to the announcement from the office of Funk and Wagnalls Company. It is the intention of the new publication not only to cover the literary activities of the United States but of all of the nations in the world, and to chronicle the news of books in much the same way as the Digest handles the news of the current happenings of the times. Clifford Smythe, for many years the editor of the New York Times book review section, is to be in charge of the new publication which already numbers among its contributors Sinclair Lewis, Vilhjalm Stefansson, Irving Bacheller, Richard Garnett and Luigi Pirandello.

Books reviewed in this column can be found at the local library.

From The Pulpit

Sermon by A. H. Lathrop, D. D. of Methodist Church.

Text—"Hast Thou entered into the treasures of the snow?" Job 38-22.
Emerson wrote—
"Come see the north wind's masonry,
Round every windward stake
Or tree, or house or door.
The mad wind's night work,
The frolic architecture of the snow."

There is Intellectual treasure in the snow. The United States weather bureau reports 1,000 different forms of flakes, each made of thousands of crystals and each crystal a unique geometrical figure. Under microscope, what lines, proportions, cunning workmanship and tapestry patterns the snow flake reveals. It is frozen mathematics. A poem in frost. The perfect product of God's perfect law. So He works everywhere, "The law of the Lord is perfect converting the soul."

There is Agricultural treasure in snow. It enriches and recuperates the soil. It is the poor man's fertilizer. It combines with frost to make the ground fallow. Then it is Mother Nature's blanket for the baby wheat. The great fields lie in the snow belts. The snow reports itself in grain and food.

Snow is warm vapor, frozen. So the cold currents of trouble and adversity chill and freeze the warm currents of human happiness. Sorrow is frozen joy. The greater the joy, winter-caught, the greater the sorrow. But troubles bravely met, develop one's life. Human harvests, too, come from under the snow drifts of the heart.

There is Domestic treasure in snow. The temperate zones are the home-zones and where great men and women are found. Outside of a comparatively narrow belt around the world no great persons have arisen. Life, outside of vegetation, animals, fish and birds, degenerates as you go toward the equator. North America has eclipsed South America, in human life quality. The fundamental trouble with Mexico is, she is too near the equator.

The home is the shuttle that weaves all our blessings. It antedates church and state and is their foundation. When the country loses the "home" from the hearts of the people, the country is lost.

Snow conserves the home. It drives us in around its hearth and compels its fires to burn brightly. It gives opportunity for fellowship, acquaintance and mutual love. It makes home mean something more than just a place to eat and sleep. Something more than a club. It makes home a